

Forks exploit multiple targets

Thinking And Training

THE IDEA

A fork attacks two or more targets at once. The targets must matter, and the opponent must lack a response that saves both or creates something stronger. Knights are famous for forks, but every piece, including pawns and kings, can double-attack.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A knight check that also attacks a rook is often powerful because the king must answer the check. A fork of two protected pawns may win nothing. Count the actual gain after the defender's best reply.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you verify after spotting a fork square?

ANSWER AND REASONING

The forking move is legal, the piece cannot simply be captured, and the opponent cannot answer with a stronger check or counterattack. Then calculate which target is won.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

A fork is a promise that must survive the reply.